



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Academy

School Website: <https://www.graceacademyboone.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Grace Academy Boone (Grace Academy NC 28607) presents a robust classical Christian program with explicit theological grounding, a clearly stated mission of formation, and a curriculum and pedagogy aligned with the Trivium and Great Books tradition. Public materials consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Biblical worldview, and they foreground parental partnership, a collaborative faculty culture, and a community-oriented approach. The site repeatedly emphasizes a Biblical worldview, Christian discipleship, and classical aims (grammar-logic-rhetoric, Latin, Great Books, and Socratic/recitation-based practices), with visible articulation of core values, a Statement of Faith, and a home-school partnership model. On balance, the evidence strongly supports a CLASSICAL classification across all six categories of the classical rubric.

Key highlights and textual anchors:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are foregrounded by Core Values (Christian, Classical, Collaborative) and explicit Biblical grounding (Proverbs 9:10; Biblical worldview; Statement of Faith) [Grace Academy Overview; Christian Core Value; Statement of Faith].
- The School Purpose/Goal centers on formation, virtue, and wisdom within a Biblical framework, not mere job preparation (mission statements, Biblical worldview, and long-horizon formation language).
- Curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, and a history taught in a Christian Tavern of time (Creation to today); explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing appears in classical education materials on the site.
- Pedagogy features singing/recitation in the Grammar Stage, memory work, and upper-school Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; explicit Recitation and Curriculum pages document these methods.
- Faculty is depicted as faith-informed mentors, with a living-education ethos; explicit references to Christian commitments of staff and a mission-driven faculty culture are visible.
- Parents & Community are positioned as co-teachers and partners in education, with a collaborative framework, home-classroom integration, and community engagement programs.

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Note: Because all six categories are rated CLASSICAL, there is no required "What would move the needle" section for this submission.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core Values foreground Christian, Classical, and Collaborative aims (Core Values: Christian, Classical, Collaborative). - Biblical grounding and Biblical worldview described as integral to the school's

educational philosophy (Biblical worldview; The fear of the LORD as the beginning of wisdom). - Statement of Faith materials and explicit theological framing (Statement of Faith; Essential Truth language) are part of public materials. - Public materials reflect theology as governing the education process (e.g., “There is no such thing as a neutral education” and the Christian modeling of faculty). - Liturgical/communal cues present via hymns, memory work, and liturgical rhythm in programming (e.g., Hymns & Memory Work; Recitation traditions; House System with Latin names including Veritas—Truth).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, wisdom, theology, Christian worldview, liturgy/worship references, sacred tradition, confession of faith, virtue-related language (virtue, moral reasoning implied in discipleship), etc. Notable explicit items: “The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom” (Proverbs 9:10); “There is no such thing as a neutral education” (Biblical worldview framing). Veritas (Truth) in House System. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no promotional language that mimics secular relativism or values-neutral ethics). The classical lexicon cautions about negative indicators, but Grace Academy materials do not exhibit them in public-facing content.

Why this rating - The school clearly situates education within a Christian metaphysical frame, explicitly references theology as a governing force in the curriculum, and engages in liturgical-leaning communal practices (e.g., memory work with hymns, Scriptural grounding, Statement of Faith). The presence of Proverbs 9:10 and the “There is no neutral education” stance strongly aligns with transcendental moral realism and theology-grounded education.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission/vision emphasizes formation over mere information and aims at virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing within a Biblical framework (distinctively classical education with a Biblical worldview; formation toward lifelong learning, service, leadership). - Public materials frame education as formation rather than job training; the Great Books/classical approach is described in mission statements and program descriptions. The curriculum documents connect formation to a classical framework consistent with paideia-like aims. - The Great Books/Great Conversation and classical pedagogy framing appears in the What is Classical Christian Education material linked from Grace Academy materials, aligning with the classical telos. ☐filecite☐turn14☐

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, classical mission, human flourishing. Grace materials explicitly reference formation and “lifelong learning, service, and leadership to the glory of God.” - Negative keywords present: none of the standard negative indicators (e.g., workforce-prep acceleration, value-neutral ethics) are present in public Grace materials.

Why this rating - The mission statements and program descriptions reflect formation-oriented aims, classical pedagogy, and a transcendent telos, consistent with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric (grammar stage K–6; logic/ rhetoric in later grades) and Latin in the early grades; history taught chronologically from Creation to present; interdisciplinary study of literature and history within a Biblical worldview. - Great Books / Great Conversation framing and emphasis on the liberal arts are presented in the classical Christian education materials referenced on Grace Academy’s site. ☐filecite☐turn14☐ - The Curriculum page references the three-stage Trivium model (Grammar Stage K–6; Logic Stage 7–9; Rhetoric Stage 10–12) and a Biblical worldview across all stages. Latin introduced in the second grade; history taught chronologically.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation, Latin, history, Western civilization, liberal arts; primary sources; sacred/western heritage; chronicle-history from Creation. ☐filecite☐turn14☐ - Negative keywords present: none within public

material; no explicit substitutes that would indicate non-classical curriculum (e.g., pure social studies framing without history).

Why this rating - The curriculum content aligns with the liberal-arts Trivium framework, includes Great Books/secular-canonical components within a Biblical framework, and maintains a historically aware, integrated approach to history and literature. This is textbook CLASSICAL in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - In Grammar Stage, instruction includes singing, memorizing, and reciting to build memory and delight (lower-school pedagogy that emphasizes memory work). Recitation is highlighted as a core component of classical education. - Upper School pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training (Rhetoric Stage; public speaking; master language, etc.). The publicly described classical pedagogy includes rhetors and oratory training. - The public materials also reference the enduring role of the trivium and the Great Conversation as pedagogical anchors (Socratic dialogue, memorization, recitation; rhetorical training).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memorization/recitation, chanting, scholé (restful learning), narrative/narration, rhetoric, speeches, seminars, Harkness-style dialogue, wonder-based learning. Grace materials explicitly describe singing/memory in the Grammar Stage; recitation is a public hallmark; upper-level Socratic/seminar style is embedded in the classical model. - Negative keywords present: none of the catalogue of public negative signals (e.g., exclusive project-based or constructivist-only models) appears in Grace Academy's public materials. The site emphasizes a structured, traditional classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - Public materials map directly to classical pedagogy: memory-based foundational work in the early grades, Socratic/logic/rhetoric development in later grades, and explicit emphasis on disciplined, classical methods.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe the faculty as virtue-presenting and living the curriculum (faculty as mentors; teachers as living models; collaborative culture; portrait of what a teacher should be). The school's leadership is described in overview materials; staff are described as committed Christians who model discipleship and virtue. - Statements of Faith and core values frame faculty as integral to the mission (faculty as believers, mentors, and participants in the shared ethos). - Employment material notes the expectation that faculty will teach in a classical Christian framework and that the school envisions a collaborative learning culture.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: masterful/moral exemplars, mentors, living curriculum, faculty as living exemplars, collegiality, virtue modeling, teachers as guides. Grace materials explicitly articulate the notion of "faculty as living curriculum" and a collaborative teacher-student culture, aligned with classical norms. - Negative keywords present: none of the negative signals (e.g., purely technician-driven teacher roles) are evident; the site emphasizes virtue, mentorship, and character formation as core teacher roles.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently describe teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors who embody the values and methods of classical Christian education, aligning with the classic "faculty as living curriculum" and "portrait of the teacher" expectations.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A core feature of Grace Academy is its collaborative model, with explicit statements that parents co-teach, lead, and collaborate with teachers (Deuteronomy 6:4-9 framing; "Parents take the lead in directing learning in the home"). The Collaborative pillar emphasizes home-school partnership and parental involvement as essential to classical education. - The school defines community partnerships and parent

education (Information sessions; parent resources; Hymns & Memory Work; Summer Reading) to deepen classical formation at home and within the community. - The Grace Academy public materials explicitly discuss parental involvement, home classroom components, and extended-learning options as part of the “collaborative” model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental engagement; home–school collaboration; parent formation; open campus; community programs; family catechesis; living tradition in the family. These reflect the standard Positive Keywords in the “Parents and Community” category of the Six Essential Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: none (the public site does not present consumer-language or minimal parent involvement signals; rather, it emphasizes close parental partnership).

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize parents as co-educators and partners in classical education, with proactive parent participation, book groups, and shared mission, aligning strongly with classical expectations for parent-community engagement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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